RÉSEAU COCAGNE

UNIVERSITÉ DE LORRAINE | IUT Saint-Dié

BENCHMARK

SAE 5 ENGLISH PART

Jardins de Cocagne



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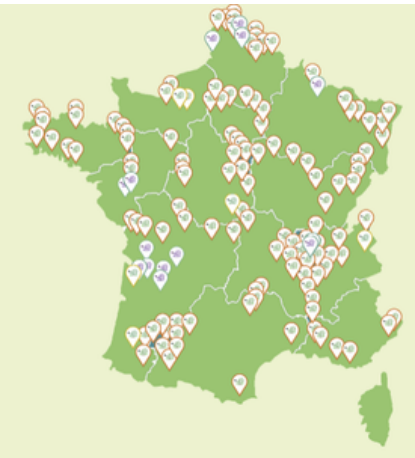
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Introduction :



The Cocagne Network (Réseau Cocagne) and the French Market In France, following a crisis that began in 2022, the organic farming sector is showing signs of a fragile recovery, driven in 2024 by a modest growth of 0.6% in a market valued at €12.2 billion. Within this landscape, the Réseau Cocagne brings together organic market gardening organizations with a social mission across France. Its model rests on three pillars:

- A permanent supervisory team.
- Workers in a socio-professional integration program (people who had difficulties finding a job).

A community of member-consumers.

Operating on the principle of a solidarity-based CSA (Community Supported Agriculture), all services are reserved exclusively for members.
Members subscribe to weekly organic vegetable baskets varying in size and content which are distributed through local pickup points.
Across the country, each local garden runs its own website to communicate with members and sell its produce.
Below is an evaluation of three different local branches to see how they use the web to run their activities.

The Cocagne Network in Numbers:

- Over 100 local gardens across France.
- More than 4,000 workers in social and professional integration each year.
- Approximately 25,000 subscribing families receiving weekly organic baskets.
- Around 800 permanent staff members managing agriculture and social mentoring.

The International CSA Market & Digital Trends

Beyond France, the Community Supported Agriculture (CSA) model is a thriving global movement, particularly well-established in North America, the United Kingdom, and Switzerland. While the French Cocagne network places a unique emphasis on socio-professional reintegration, international actors often focus on direct-to-consumer (D2C) organic distribution, regenerative agriculture, and building robust local food systems.
From a technological standpoint, these foreign initiatives frequently leverage highly advanced digital ecosystems. Instead of traditional administrative setups, international CSA farms often use seamless e-commerce subscription engines, dynamic harvest previews, and integrated community solidarity features (such as "Pay it forward" micro-donations). To provide a comprehensive benchmark, this report also evaluates several international farms to compare their digital strategies and identify best IT practices in the global organic market.

100
Jardins de Cocagne partout en France

6 000
personnes accompagnées / an

600
hectares d'agriculture bio

270 000
paniers solidaires distribués

7 000
salariés partout en France

80
% des Jardins innovent au-delà production agricole

IT Audit Methodology

The shift towards sustainable agriculture depends not only on green farming practices but also on reliable and easy-to-use digital tools. Local food networks such as Community-Supported Agriculture (CSA) in English-speaking countries and AMAPs or Jardins de Cocagne in France rely heavily on their websites to attract new members, manage harvests, organize deliveries, and process regular payments.

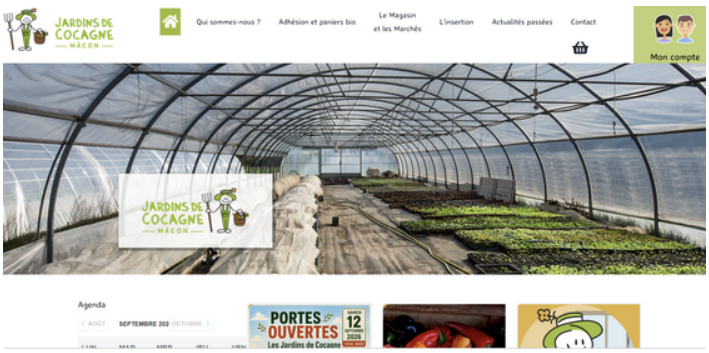
This report analyzes how these community-based farms use web technologies. By looking at how their websites are built specifically focusing on mobile design, the user journey, and account login systems this study highlights the digital roadblocks that frustrate users and prevent them from subscribing. Finally, it compares these local platforms to successful international examples to show how the digital experience can be improved.

Each platform was evaluated on five main criteria to assess its overall web quality:

- Design & Mobile Responsiveness: How well the website adapts to different screens (desktop, tablet, mobile) and how stable the visual layout is without bugs or overlaps.
- Navigation & User Experience (UX): How easily users can find information, explore the site, and complete a subscription without needing too many clicks.
- Login & Account Management: How smooth the login process is, and whether users can stay on the main website instead of being redirected to confusing or unstyled subdomains.
- E-commerce & Subscriptions: The efficiency of the online checkout process, the tools for recurring payments, and how easily members can manage or pause their deliveries for holidays.
- Technology & Backend: The core software running the website (such as WordPress, Shopify, or custom platforms) and how well it helps the organization manage its daily operations.

Competitive French market

2.1. Jardins de Cocagne de Mâcon



Primary URL: https://jdcmacon.org/

User Account URL: https://moncompte.jdcmacon.org/user

Technical & Structural Evaluation

The primary portal displays clean visual branding with clear information highlighting weekly harvest items, workshop schedules, and social insertion metrics. Responsive viewport scaling functions well on standard smartphone resolutions.
However, significant software defects and architectural disconnects undermine user retention:

- DOM Rendering Defect (CSS Layout Engine): On the homepage, the desktop calendar component fails container boundaries: its container width overflows into the adjacent right-hand content column, overlapping text blocks. This indicates missing CSS flex-wrap or improperly configured Grid template bounds (overflow: hidden / min-width: 0), degrading visual trustworthiness.
- Disjointed Authentication & Identity Silo: Authenticating redirects the user from the main showcase domain (jdcmacon.org) to an unstyled sub-domain (moncompte.jdcmacon.org/user) running an isolated legacy Drupal/PHP form. The visual identity drops completely: background branding disappears, replaced by an unstyled grey HTML form.
- Session & Cart Limitations: The customer dashboard lacks self-service asynchronous capabilities (AJAX/Fetch API). Subscribers cannot edit cart contents in place or toggle holiday pauses without submitting tickets or awaiting batch synchronization.

Strengths	Weaknesses	Opportunities	Threats
• Fluid CSS media queries ensuring standard smartphone compatibility.	• Severe CSS Flexbox/Grid overflow bug causing desktop calendar elements to overlap adjacent DOM containers.	Unify showcase and authentication layers using a single-domain SPA architecture or Headless CMS.	• High bounce rate and checkout drop-off caused by visual disorientation during subdomain redirection.
• Regular database-driven updates for weekly basket content and agricultural agendas.	• Architectural isolation of identity provider (moncompte.jdcmacon.org) dropping global UI context and brand equity.	• Implement modern token-based Single Sign-On (OAuth2/OIDC) for frictionless session persistence.	• Technical debt accumulation from maintaining two disconnected codebases and CMS stacks.
• Dedicated sub-domain endpoint provisioned for user account management.	• Absence of asynchronous CRUD interactions (AJAX/Fetch) for client self-service (vacations, swaps).	• Expose RESTful/GraphQL endpoints allowing direct basket customization and recurring payment webhooks.	• Manual workload placed on administrative staff to process basket exceptions.

2.2. Jardins de Cocagne Oasis



Primary URL: https://oasis.bio/
Member Platform: oasis.cocagnebio.fr

Technical & Structural Evaluation

The main website (oasis.bio) features a warm, accessible aesthetic, presenting farm workshops, eco-maintenance services, and urgent solidarity campaigns (e.g., crowdfunding a replacement refrigerated delivery truck). Page assets load quickly, and typography renders cleanly across mobile devices.

The architectural breakdown occurs in Information Architecture (IA) and conversion paths:
Severe Navigation Anti-Pattern (Hidden Auth Anchor): The site lacks a global header utility link .
To access their portal, existing subscribers must navigate to Paniers Bio, scroll down multiple page tiers, and locate a plain-text hyperlinked anchor pointing to oasis.cocagnebio.fr.

Fragmented Domain Footprint: Users jump between an independent promotional web application (oasis.bio) and a national syndicated legacy application (cocagnebio.fr). There is no shared header/footer, no unified state management, and no shared cookie domain.

Absence of Self-Service API: Subscription management remains semi-manual. Modifying delivery locations or pausing memberships requires advance notification via email or mail, burdening administrative personnel with high operational overhead.

Strengths	Weaknesses	Opportunities	Threats
Clean semantic HTML structure and optimized asset delivery leading to low First Contentful Paint (FCP).	Critical navigation anti-pattern: complete absence of an authentication CTA in the global navigation bar.	Implement a persistent global navbar with a high-visibility, modal-driven authentication module.	High user drop-off due to poor discoverability of the subscriber space.
Fully responsive mobile-first typography and interface design.	Member login entry-point relegated to an unstyled text anchor at the bottom of an interior page.	Unify the brand into a singular ecosystem with centralized API management.	Administrative bottlenecks stemming from manual email processing of holiday holds and cancellations.
Functional third-party micro-funnel integration for emergency solidarity crowdfunding.	Fragmented multi-domain topology (oasis.bio vs oasis.cocagnebio.fr) preventing shared sessions and cross-origin state	Automate recurring billing and dynamic absence handling through integrated FinTech webhooks (e.g., Stripe, Mollie).	Security and certificate overhead related to multi-domain routing.
	Absence of automated self-service APIs for basket hold requests or location switches.		

2.3. Jardins de Cocagne de Thaon-les-Vosges



Primary URL: https://jardins-cocagne-thaon.fr/

Technical & Structural Evaluation

Thaon-les-Vosges represents the most visually refined implementation within the audited French sample. The design is professional, the hero section utilizes high-resolution imagery showcasing workforce diversity, and the site highlights subsidiary services (on-site organic restaurant, zero-waste grocery store, corporate workshops).

- Pickup Point Geolocation: The pickup directory utilizes an interactive Leaflet/OpenStreetMap wrapper detailing physical pickup lockers, PIN code procedures, and real-time schedules.

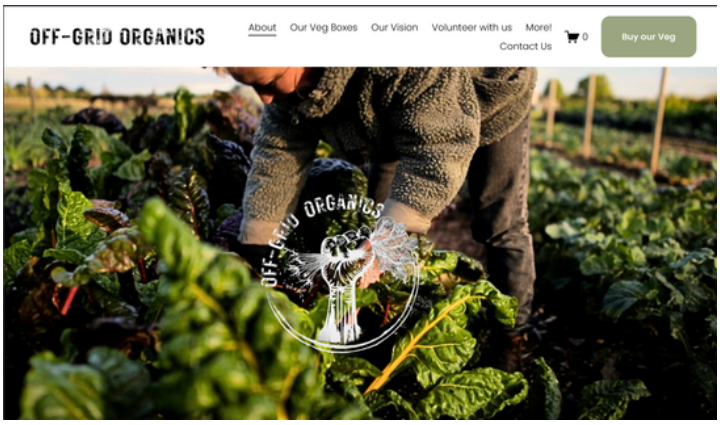
- The "Digital Facade" Trap (Incomplete Transactional Funnel): While the UI displays modern call-to-action buttons ("S'inscrire en ligne"), the back-end does not feature an actual transactional subscription engine. The user is simply routed to an online pre-registration lead form (Typeform/Gravity Forms style) or prompted to download a printable PDF form.

- No Direct Billing Integration: The platform lacks an online payment gateway . The digital journey abruptly stops at lead collection, requiring farm staff to manually verify IBANs, telephone prospects, and maintain paper files

Strengths	Weaknesses	Opportunities	Threats
Contemporary UI design with optimized layout hierarchy and high-resolution visual assets.	"Digital Facade" anti-pattern: front-end UI does not connect to a transactional subscription engine.	Convert static pre-registration forms into a full end-to-end digital onboarding funnel with instant SEPA direct debit mandate setup.	Severe funnel abandonment during the transition from digital pre-registration to physical/paper contracts.
Dynamic geolocation directory leveraging interactive Leaflet/OpenStreetMap layers with locker coordinates and PIN access codes.	Complete absence of an authenticated user area or persistent member account database.	Develop a native customer portal for self-service locker reallocation and delivery rescheduling.	High rate of human error and processing delays during manual transcription of customer data.
Online pre-registration web form streamlining initial prospect lead capture.	Zero automated payment processing; subscriptions rely on offline SEPA mandates and manual PDF printing.	Connect an automated inventory database to dynamically flag available locker slots in real time.	Total inability to track digital user retention, lifetime value (LTV), or churn metrics.

International Competition

3.1. Offgrid organics



Primary URL: https://www.offgridorganics.co.uk/

Technical & Structural Evaluation

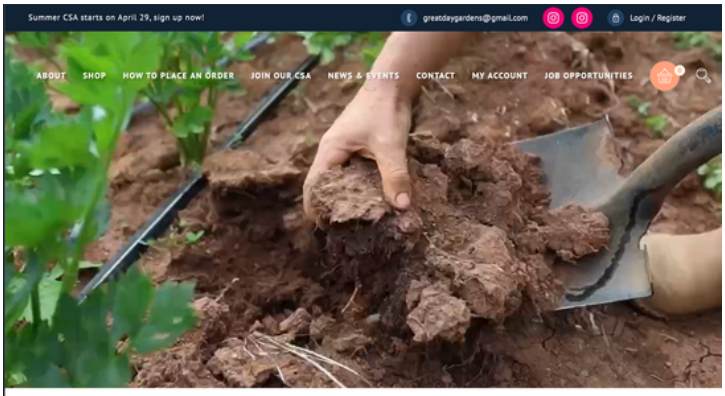
Off-Grid Organics is a small organic farm located in Sparkford, Somerset, in the United Kingdom. It operates under the Community Supported Agriculture (CSA) model, which allows members of the local community to support the farm by subscribing to vegetable baskets for a season. The farm offers locally grown organic vegetables sold directly to consumers. It also offers complementary products such as organic eggs and flowers.

The store offers several subscription options, including baskets of various sizes. For the 2026–2027 season, for example, customers can choose between a standard basket and a larger one. The subscription runs for 40 weeks and can be canceled. It is also possible to pay for the entire season in advance.

However, there are a few issues worth noting. The store and the main website are separate, which can make the user experience less seamless. The store's interface is also fairly simple and less visually polished than the main website. Finally, certain advanced account and subscription management features are not particularly highlighted on the interface.

Strengths	Weaknesses	Opportunities	Threats
the website provides access to a dedicated online shop where users can subscribe to vegetable boxes and add products such as eggs or flowers.	the online store is hosted on a different subdomain, which makes the experience less unified between the main website and the shop.	integrating the shop directly into the main website could make navigation smoother and give users a more consistent experience.	moving from the main website to a separate shop can create friction and potentially cause users to leave before completing their purchase.
users can choose between different box sizes and subscribe for a 40-week season.	users mainly choose the size of their box; the website does not appear to offer an advanced system for selecting individual vegetables.	users could manage their subscription, payments, delivery preferences and previous orders from one account.	other CSA organisations may offer more advanced online ordering and account-management systems.
products have dedicated pages with prices and options, making the purchasing process relatively straightforward.	compared with a modern e-commerce platform, the shop has relatively basic filtering, search and personalization features.	a more optimized mobile shopping interface could make subscriptions and orders easier to complete on smartphones.	having content on two different websites can potentially create inconsistencies between the information presented on the main site and the shop.

3.2. Great Day Gardens



Primary URL: https://greatdaygardens.com/

Great Day Gardens is a small organic-style farm located in Forest, Virginia, in the United States, serving the greater Lynchburg area. It operates as a direct-to-consumer online marketplace combined with a seasonal CSA program. The farm offers a wide range of products beyond vegetables, including live plants, seeds, flowers, and baked goods such as bread, along with grains, flour, and cheese.

Website review:
The Great Day Gardens website combines the farm's presentation, its CSA program and its online shop within the same website. This creates a relatively consistent user experience because customers do not need to leave the main website to access the shop. The website also provides information about pickup locations and allows customers to place orders online.

The CSA system is based on a farmer's-choice model. Customers receive a selection of vegetables chosen by the farm rather than selecting every product themselves. The website also allows members to purchase additional products such as bread, eggs, flowers and other products. The 2026 CSA requires payment at the beginning of the season, and customers receive electronic invoices that can be paid using several methods, including ACH, cash, check or credit card.
The online shop uses a standard e-commerce structure, with products organized into categories and individual product pages. Customers can therefore purchase products separately from their CSA membership. The website also provides several pickup options, which makes the ordering process relatively practical.

However, the website remains relatively simple from a technical point of view. The CSA system focuses mainly on registration and payment rather than offering advanced subscription management. Customers cannot freely customize the contents of their weekly CSA share because the farm uses a farmer's-choice model. The website also provides limited advanced search or filtering features for the online catalogue.

Strengths	Weaknesses	Opportunities	Threats
the website includes a complete online marketplace where users can browse products, add them to a cart and place orders.	the shop mainly organizes products by categories, with limited advanced filtering or personalization.	the website could allow members to manage their CSA subscription, orders, payment information and pickup preferences from one dashboard.	other farms may offer more flexible subscriptions and more sophisticated online ordering systems.
visitors can create an account, log in and reset their password.	the website does not appear to provide many advanced features for managing subscriptions, preferences or deliveries from the user account.	adding filters by product type, availability, price or season could make the shop easier to use..	customers who want to choose individual vegetables may prefer another CSA because Great Day Gardens uses a farmer's-choice system.
the online shop offers vegetables, flowers, plants, seeds, bread, grains, flour and cheese.	CSA members cannot choose their individual vegetables; the content of the box is selected by the farm.	members could manage skipped weeks, pickup changes or subscription renewals directly online.	products and CSA options change according to the season, which can make the online catalogue less stable.
customers can order online and choose between card payment or cash/check at pickup.	online orders must be collected at one of the available pickup locations.	improving the mobile shopping experience could make online ordering easier for customers.	if the e-commerce or account system has technical problems, customers may have difficulty ordering or managing their accounts.

3.3. Long Lane Farm



Primary URL: https://longlanefarmri.com/

Long Lane Farm is a small organic produce farm located in Warren, Rhode Island, in the United States. The farm grows vegetables and microgreens and offers several ways for customers to purchase its products. Its main online service is a weekly vegetable membership based on a CSA model. The farm also operates an online shop and a farm stand where customers can purchase fresh produce.

Website review:

The Long Lane Farm website has a simple and relatively clear structure. The homepage presents the farm, its products and its different purchasing options. Customers can directly access the online shop or information about the weekly vegetable membership. This makes the main services relatively easy to identify.

The most interesting feature is the Weekly Veggie Membership. The CSA lasts for 18 weeks and offers both weekly and bi-weekly options. Unlike a traditional farmer's-choice CSA, the system allows members to choose the vegetables they want each week. This gives customers more control over the contents of their basket.

The membership also includes additional services such as weekly emails containing recipe ideas, invitations to community events, discounts on bulk products and guides designed to help members reduce food waste. This creates a connection between the digital service and the customer's overall experience with the farm.

The website also presents an online shop and information about the farm stand. However, the interface remains relatively simple and does not appear to provide many advanced account-management features. The main website focuses more on presenting the farm and its offers than on providing a complete digital customer-management platform.

Strengths	Weaknesses	Opportunities	Threats
the website provides an online shop where customers can purchase the farm's products.	the site does not appear to provide an advanced personal dashboard for customers to manage orders or subscriptions.	customers could manage their CSA membership, orders and pickup preferences from one account.	other CSA organisations may provide more sophisticated online ordering and account-management systems.
users can register for a weekly or bi-weekly CSA membership directly online.	customers still need to come to the farm during specific pickup times, rather than using a fully automated delivery system.	users could modify or manage their pickup dates directly online.	customers looking for delivery or more flexible pickup options may prefer another service.
the website offers both weekly and bi-weekly membership plans.	although the CSA allows customers to choose vegetables, there does not appear to be an advanced digital interface for reserving specific products before pickup.	advanced search, filters and product availability could make the shop easier to use.	the online store and CSA are strongly linked to the farming season, so the availability of online products changes during the year.
the website uses digital forms for contact, employment applications and consulting requests.	CSA information, online shopping and farm-stand information are separated across several sections of the website.	CSA registration, shopping, account management and communication could be brought together in one unified interface.	important information such as opening dates and farm-stand hours is partly communicated through email and social media.

3.4. Dharma Farm



Primary URL: https://www.dharma.farm/

Dharma Farm is a small farm located in Washington, Maine, in the United States. The farm grows vegetables, herbs and seedlings using no-till and bio-intensive farming methods. It offers several ways for customers to purchase its products, including an online store, farmers' markets and a CSA program.

Website review:

The Dharma Farm website has a simple structure focused mainly on presenting the farm, its products and its different purchasing options. The homepage provides information about the farm and gives users access to the online store and CSA registration.

The online store is particularly interesting from a technical point of view. Customers can select products from different categories, including fresh vegetables and seedlings. They can place orders online and select a specific pickup date. Orders are then prepared and placed in a designated cooler at the farm, where customers can collect them.

The website also offers two types of CSA credit: Online Store CSA Credit and Farmers' Market CSA Credit. This system allows customers to purchase credit and use it to buy products either through the online store or at the farmers' market.

Another interesting aspect is that the website supports different types of activities. In addition to direct sales, Dharma Farm provides information about its farmers' markets and wholesale activity. This means that the website serves several purposes rather than functioning only as an online shop. However, the website remains relatively simple compared with a more advanced CSA management platform. The online store mainly focuses on ordering products and selecting a pickup date. There is no highly developed customer dashboard visible on the main website, and the subscription management features appear more limited than those of platforms specifically designed for CSA management.

Strengths	Weaknesses	Opportunities	Threats
he website provides an online store where customers can pre-order fresh vegetables and seedlings.	there does not appear to be a prominent advanced customer dashboard for managing orders or personal preferences.	users could manage their CSA credit, orders and personal information from one account.	other farms may offer more sophisticated subscription and account-management systems.
users can sign up for the CSA directly from the website.	the online store mainly focuses on placing orders for pickup rather than providing extensive post-order management features.	users could filter products by type, availability or season.	customers looking for home delivery or more flexible online management may prefer another service.
customers can select products and a pickup date before coming to the farm.	online orders are designed around physical pickup rather than home delivery.	customers could manage their CSA subscription and credit balance directly online.	technical problems with the online store could prevent customers from placing pre-orders.

Comparative Benchmark Summary

French Company

Organization / Platform	Country	Strengths / Assets	Weaknesses
Jardins de Cocagne de Mâcon	France	• Regular updates on basket contents via CMS. • Dedicated login endpoint (moncompte). • Responsive mobile layout	• Desktop CSS overflow bug breaking layout. • Visually disconnected authentication subdomain. • No automated client self-service (swaps, holds). • Dedicated customer portal
Jardins de Cocagne Oasis	France	· Clean HTML structure and low FCP load times. · Integrated third-party donation campaign widget. · Clean typography on smartphones.	· Major navigation anti-pattern: login link hidden in subpage text. · Two separate platforms with no shared session. · Manual email-based process for holiday holds.
Jardins de Cocagne Thaon-les-Vosges	France (Vosges)	· Modern UI with dynamic mapping (Leaflet API). · Interactive locker codes and pickup schedule display. · Online pre-registration intake form.	· "Digital facade": no real backend transactional engine. · Absence of user account system or customer portal. · Zero online payment (requires paper/PDF workflow).

Comparative Benchmark Summary

International Competition

Organization / Platform	Country	Strengths / Assets	Weaknesses
Offgrid organics	United Kingdom	• Online CSA subscription system with different box options. • Integrated online shop for additional products. • Online payment and recurring subscription functionality.	• Online shop hosted on a separate subdomain. • Limited customer self-service and account-management features. • Basic product search and filtering capabilities.
Great Day Gardens	United States	• Full online marketplace with product categories and shopping cart. • Customer account and authentication system. • Online ordering with multiple pickup options.	• Limited advanced account-management functionality. • Limited search, filtering and personalization. • CSA system does not provide advanced online customization of individual products.
Long Lane Farm	United States	• Online CSA registration with weekly and bi-weekly options. • Online shop for farm products. • Digital communication through regular member emails.	• Limited customer account and subscription management . • Basic e-commerce functionality with limited filtering. • Pickup and membership management remain partly manual.
Dharma Farm	United States	• Online store for pre-ordering products. • Online CSA registration and credit system. • Product categories and selectable pickup dates.	• Limited customer dashboard and post-order management. • Pickup-oriented system with no advanced delivery management. • Different CSA credit systems can make the purchasing process less intuitive.

International Competition

IT Recommendations & Strategic Roadmap

To modernize digital platforms, empower customers, and reduce administrative burdens, we recommend a four-phase approach:

- Phase 1: UX & Platform Integration
  Improve navigation and create a more consistent user experience between the main websites and external online shops. Make important functions such as login, subscriptions and online ordering immediately visible.

- Phase 2: Customer Account & Self-Service
  Develop a centralized customer dashboard where members can manage their profile, subscriptions, orders, pickup dates and payment information without contacting the organization.

- Phase 3: Automated Subscription & Payment Management
  Automate recurring payments, subscription renewals and order confirmations. Allow customers to modify or pause their subscriptions directly from their account.

- Phase 4: Advanced E-Commerce
Introduce advanced search and filtering, real-time product availability and personalized product recommendations. A dynamic preview of upcoming CSA products could also help customers plan their orders.

The overall objective is to move from simple informational websites and basic online shops toward integrated digital platforms that provide greater autonomy for customers while reducing manual administrative processes.

Conclusion

This comparative analysis highlights a difference between French and international platforms:

In France: The Jardins de Cocagne websites are informative and visually appealing, but they lack comprehensive digital workflows. Subscription options and customer accounts are often missing, hard to find, or scattered across external sites, requiring manual administrative steps and email exchanges to sign up.

International platforms provide more transactional features, such as online shops, CSA subscriptions, online registration, customer accounts and pre-ordering. However, these services are sometimes fragmented across different platforms and still offer limited customer self-service.

The goal of our project is therefore clear: to build a modern, unified web platform that combines public communication with a simple, automated member portal.